

Perennial Flowering Plants — Agent-Grade Care Narrative (Priority Tagged)

Purpose: agent-readable horticultural narrative for generating care schedules and cautions. Priority tags: P1=survival-critical, P2=establishment success, P3=optimization, P4=advanced/reference. P1 statements are conservative and exception-aware.

A. Site & Light Requirements (P1)

- Species varies: follow tag for sun/shade.
- Wrong exposure reduces establishment and bloom.

B. Temperature & Climate Constraints (P1)

- Plant when soil is workable; avoid frozen/waterlogged soil.
- Heat stress increases transplant failure; avoid planting into prolonged extreme heat.
- Cold zones: allow ~6 weeks before hard freeze for fall plantings.

C. Seasonal Timing / Planting Window (P1)

- Best: spring or early fall (allow rooting before extremes).
- Avoid planting during peak summer heat without irrigation/shade plan.
- Avoid winter planting in frozen/waterlogged soils; mild climates may plant in winter if soil workable.

D. Watering & Moisture Profile (Day 0–30) (P1)

- Water in thoroughly at planting.
- First 2 weeks: check moisture daily; water deeply as needed to keep root zone evenly moist.
- After 2 weeks: water when soil begins to dry; avoid saturation (many perennials dislike wet feet).

E. Soil Requirements (P2)

- Drainage critical for many perennials; consider raised bed in heavy soils.
- pH preferences vary; follow tag for acid-loving or lime-loving species.

F. Planting & Installation Rules (P1)

- Plant at same depth as in container (crown at soil surface for most perennials).
- Mulch lightly around, not over, the crown.
- Remove only damaged tissue at planting.

G. Fertilization Guidance (P2)

- Avoid fertilizing heat- or drought-stressed plants.
- Prefer compost/soil prep; fertilize lightly only after new growth indicates rooting.

H. Pest & Disease Risk (Early Window) (P2)

- Slugs/snails increase in wet conditions; manage with sanitation/barriers.

- Crown rot risk if crowns are buried or soil stays saturated.

I. Weed Competition Sensitivity (P2)

- Keep weeds down; avoid deep cultivation near new roots.

J. Weather Exception Handling (P1)

- Heat: temporary shade and more frequent watering; avoid wetting foliage mid-day.
- Frost: cover tender new transplants if a hard freeze is forecast soon after planting.
- Heavy rain: ensure drainage; pull mulch back from crowns if staying wet.

K. Growth & Establishment Signals (P2)

- Normal: slower growth in year 1; mild dieback after transplant.
- Concerning: mushy crown, persistent wilt with wet soil, rapid blackening of stems.

L. Safety & Customer Guardrails (P1)

- Do not bury crowns.
- Do not plant into waterlogged soil.

M. Location-Based Modifiers (P2)

- Cold zones: prioritize spring planting or early fall with winter protection; avoid late fall planting.
- Hot zones: favor fall/winter planting where soil stays workable to reduce heat stress.

N. Lifecycle Transition (Post 30 Days) (P4)

- Species-specific division/pruning/fertilization after establishment.